



🇪🇸 **Day 09 · Thursday, Aug 27, 2026 · VALENCIA → MADRID + FLAMENCO** 🇪🇸

Prepared for Divyansh · Pure-Vegetarian Edition · Europe 2026



Divyansh · Solo · PURE VEGETARIAN (no meat, no fish, no seafood) **Base tonight:** NH Madrid Paseo de la Habana (Chamartín) **Headline:** Half-day travel Valencia → Madrid, then your first Spanish-capital evening — Gran Vía, Sol, Plaza Mayor, veg dinner, and a ☒ **booked flamenco show**.

🗣️ Veg phrase (memorize): _"Soy vegetariano estricto, sin carne ni pescado ni marisco."_ (I am a strict vegetarian — no meat, no fish, no seafood.)

🕒 **WAKE / LEAVE**

- **Morning departure Valencia → Madrid** is on the WanderOn group train/coach — the guide sets the exact time and handles the tickets. Confirm the call time the night before, be packed and at the lobby on time (you check out of the Valencia hotel for good).

- Have all bags zipped and labeled before you come down. Keep any seat/bag info the guide gives you.
- 🟡 **Optional before leaving** (only if the schedule allows and you have energy): the **City of Arts & Sciences** — Valencia's futuristic white Calatrava complex (Hemisfèric, Science Museum, Oceanogràfic). Great photos even from outside. Skip guilt-free if departure is early or you're wrecked from Tomatina — the Madrid evening is the priority.

TRANSPORT

- **Valencia → Madrid:** WanderOn train/coach, included.
- By high-speed **AVE train ≈ 1h50m**; by coach it's longer (~4h). Either way, it's a half-day of transit and you land with the evening free.
- **Airport note for later (not tonight):** NH Paseo de la Habana is ~13 km / ~20 min from **Madrid-Barajas (MAD)**. Route for the early Paris flight on Aug 29: **Metro Line 8** from "Aeropuerto" to "Colombia," or **taxi ≈ €33** (fixed airport fare). Note it now so that dawn morning is stress-free.

HOURLY-HOURLY — MADRID EVENING

Time	What	Why
Afternoon	Arrive Madrid, check in at NH Paseo de la Habana , drop bags, freshen up	Reset after the train
~18:00–18:30	Metro/taxi to the center (Gran Vía / Sol)	Head into town
Evening walk	Gran Vía → Puerta del Sol → Plaza Mayor	The three central sights, all walkable together (see below)
~20:00	 Veg dinner (Lavapiés Indian or Artemisa)	Fuel before the show — see food section
~20:45 (arrive ~20:15–20:30)	 FLAMENCO SHOW  booked — QR ready	The evening's centerpiece

The three central sights (walkable loop):

- **Gran Vía** — Madrid's grand boulevard, the "Spanish Broadway": theaters, neon, early-20th-century architecture. Best walked at dusk as it lights up.
- **Puerta del Sol** — the literal heart of Spain (Kilómetro Cero, where all Spanish roads are measured), the bear-and-strawberry-tree statue (_El Oso y el Madroño_), and the famous clock. Always alive.
- **Plaza Mayor** — the grand 17th-century arcaded square, uniform red facades, cafés under the arches, street performers. The classic Madrid postcard. (Just south: Mercado de San Miguel)

food hall.)

TICKETS

- 🎭 **Flamenco show** — ✅ **booked, QR ready.** Show typically **~8:45 PM**.
- Keep the **QR / e-ticket screenshotted offline** — it's your entry, and tablaos can have patchy signal.
- **Arrive ~20 minutes early (by ~20:15–20:30).** Tablaos are intimate and often seat by arrival order — early = closer to the stage.
- Authentic, high-energy: guitar, singing, _palmas_, powerful dance. A perfect low-effort but memorable first Madrid night.

VEGETARIAN FOOD — Madrid is easy for veg

- ★ **Indian veg near Lavapiés** — Madrid's South-Asian quarter. Take the Metro toward **Lavapiés** for reliable pure-veg Indian: **thalis, dosas, paneer curries, dal** — great comfort food and the best pre-flamenco option.
- **Artemisa** — well-known **vegetarian tapas** spot near Sol: croquetas de verdura, veg paella, salads, grilled vegetables. A certain choice close to the sights.
- **Mercado de San Miguel** (by Plaza Mayor) — gourmet food hall for a light graze: **patatas bravas, pan con tomate, Spanish tortilla** (potato omelette), cheeses, olives. Confirm ingredients.
- Spanish dinner runs late — eating ~20:00 before a ~20:45 show works perfectly; or a fuller meal after (~22:00) if you'd rather.
- Use **HappyCow** to lock a nearby all-veg spot, and the veg phrase above.

TIPS

- Confirm the exact WanderOn departure the night before and pack everything — you're leaving Valencia for good.
- Keep the flamenco QR **offline** and arrive ~20 min early for good seats.
- Note the NH ↔ MAD airport route now (Metro L8 via Colombia / taxi €33) — you need it for the early Paris flight on Aug 29.
- **Comfortable shoes** — the Gran Vía / Sol / Plaza Mayor loop is real walking after a travel day.
- After the brutal Ibiza/Tomatina stretch, keep tonight balanced: sights + food + flamenco, then rest. Tomorrow is the Toledo day trip.

Movies, Songs & Pop Culture Here (Bollywood + Hollywood)

Madrid is the **capital of Pedro Almodóvar** — Spain's most celebrated director shot much of his work in and around these streets: **_Volver_**, **_Women on the Verge of a Nervous Breakdown_**, and the Oscar-winning **_All About My Mother_**. As you walk **Gran Vía** and the old center, you're moving through his cinematic Madrid.

- **_Open Your Eyes / Abre los ojos_ (1997)** — the twisty Spanish thriller set in Madrid, later remade by Hollywood as **_Vanilla Sky_** (Tom Cruise).
- **_The Day of the Beast (El día de la Bestia)_** — the cult horror-comedy that famously climaxes on the **Schweppes tower on Gran Vía / Plaza de Callao** — glance up at that building as you pass.
- **Flamenco's spiritual home is Andalusia**, but Madrid's tablaos are where most travelers first see it live — tonight's show is that tradition up close.
-  Exact spots to feel it: **Gran Vía** (Almodóvar + **_Day of the Beast_** skyline), **Plaza Mayor** and **Puerta del Sol** (postcard Madrid seen in countless Spanish films).

 **One-line:** Pack + WanderOn train/coach Valencia→Madrid (optional City of Arts & Sciences first) → check in at NH Paseo de la Habana → dusk walk Gran Vía + Puerta del Sol + Plaza Mayor → Lavapiés Indian veg dinner ~20:00 → ~8:45 PM  booked flamenco (arrive early, QR ready) → rest.

 *Film-location thread runs through the trip · full repo: github.com/divyanshh/trip*